

Amul

The Taste Of India..

“Case Study: Analysis on Amul’s Moment Marketing Strategy”

Introduction:

Name: Amul (Anand Milk Union Limited)

Industry: Dairy and FMCG

Founded: 1946

Headquarters: Anand, Gujarat, India

Brand Icon: Amul Girl

Tagline: *"The Taste of India"*

What Is Moment Marketing?

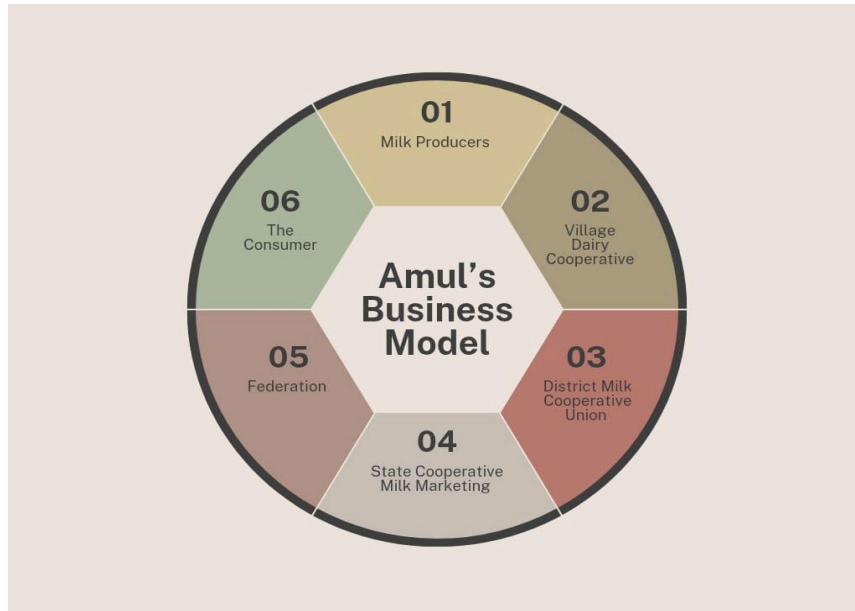
Moment marketing is about creating content around current events, pop culture, and trends that can feature the brand in a relevant way. It helps brands establish a common ground with their customers and relate to them. Moment-based marketing is often spontaneous, humorous, engaging, relatable, and relevant to current events. The key to successful moment marketing campaigns is proactivity.

Objective:

For an analysis of Amul’s moment marketing approach – how they tap real-time events to roll out hard-hitting, clever campaigns that elevate the brand’s visibility and customer engagement. It also demonstrates the kind of strategy and analysis you need for moment marketing.

Amul Business Model:

Amul operates on a unique cooperative business model driven by its commitment to the welfare of dairy farmers and consumers.



Amul's Market Segments:

B2B : [Retailers,Food Businesses,Hospitality,Industry]- Beyond selling to end consumers, Amul supplies dairy ingredients to bakeries, restaurants, and food manufacturers. They offer special bulk packaging and consistent quality that commercial kitchens depend on. Amul also works with hotels and catering services, providing branded butter chipleets and cheese portions. This **B2B segment** creates stable demand for Amul's products.

B2C: [Urban & Rural Households]- In cities, Amul focuses on busy families who need convenient yet nutritious food options. They offer small packs for single urban professionals and larger sizes for families. In rural areas, Amul provides basic dairy products that are

affordable and have good shelf life despite refrigeration challenges. The brand adjusts packaging and sizes to suit different household needs.

Amul's Moment Marketing:

The Amul campaign was started by Sylvester daCunha in 1966 along with illustrator Eustace Fernandes and Usha Katrak and a few others. At that time newspaper/print media was very expensive and there was no television. The best option they had was outdoor media to inform people about their brand. The first topical advertisement came out in March 1966. According to the managing director at GCMMF (the Gujarat Co-operative Milk Marketing Federation, which makes Amul products), these topical campaigns only take up about 0.8% of their total marketing budget. Amul is a dairy product brand. They understand their target audience; young India. So they undertake a level of responsibility in their ads. The responsibility is for bite-sized, quirky, and relevant content.

Amul's Marketing & Branding Strategy:

1. Product Mix: Amul's product mix follows a simple rule: start with basic dairy products, then expand into related categories. The brand began with butter, added milk, then moved into cheese, yogurt, and ice cream. Amul also creates products for different segments – from budget options to premium varieties.

2. Price Strategy: Affordable Yet Profitable: Amul uses a “value-for-money” pricing approach. Products are priced just enough to cover costs and provide fair returns to farmers, but low enough for average families to afford. This strategy helps Amul achieve high sales volumes rather than high profit margins. By keeping prices stable even when market conditions change, Amul builds customer trust.

3. Place Strategy: Penetrating Urban and Rural Markets: Amul reaches customers through multiple channels. In cities, Amul products are available in supermarkets, small shops, and through home delivery. In rural areas, Amul works with local shops and village cooperatives. This flexible distribution strategy ensures products are accessible everywhere.

4. Experiential & Sentimental Marketing (“Amul Doodh Peeta Hai India”): Amul connects with customers through emotional campaigns. The famous “Amul Doodh

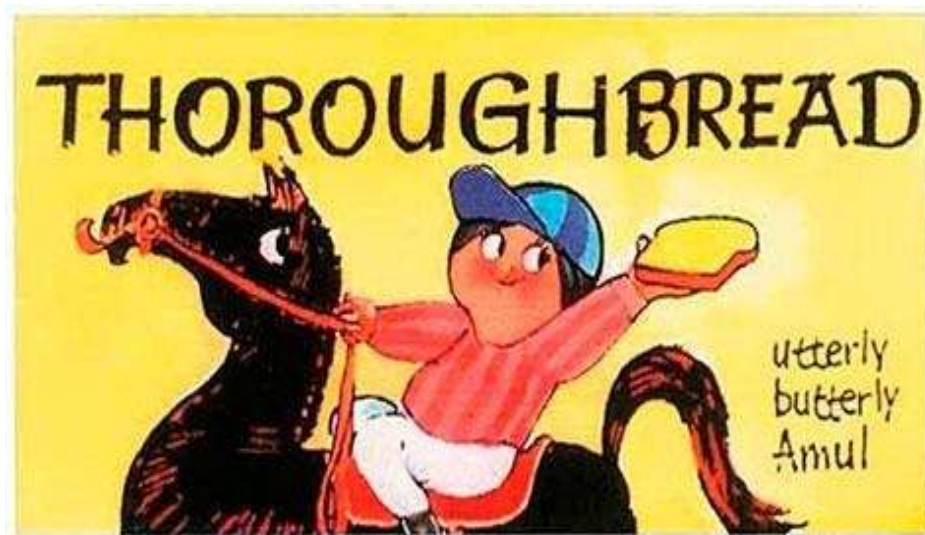
Peeta Hai India” (India drinks Amul milk) campaign linked the brand to national health and strength. Amul also sponsors sports teams and cultural events that match its wholesome image.

5. Promotion Strategy: From Billboards to Digital: Amul’s advertising is famous for being consistent yet creative. The Amul Girl topical ads have appeared on billboards for over 50 years. Amul has embraced social media with timely posts that often go viral.

Amul Moment Marketing Examples:

Amul’s secret weapon is their iconic Amul girl. This little cartoon character has been the face of their witty and creative ads for decades.

1. The very first topical ad Amul came out in 1966 when horse racing was a big deal. It featured the Amul girl riding a horse with the caption “Thoroughbred,” of course, followed by their famous slogan, “Utterly Butterly Delicious.”

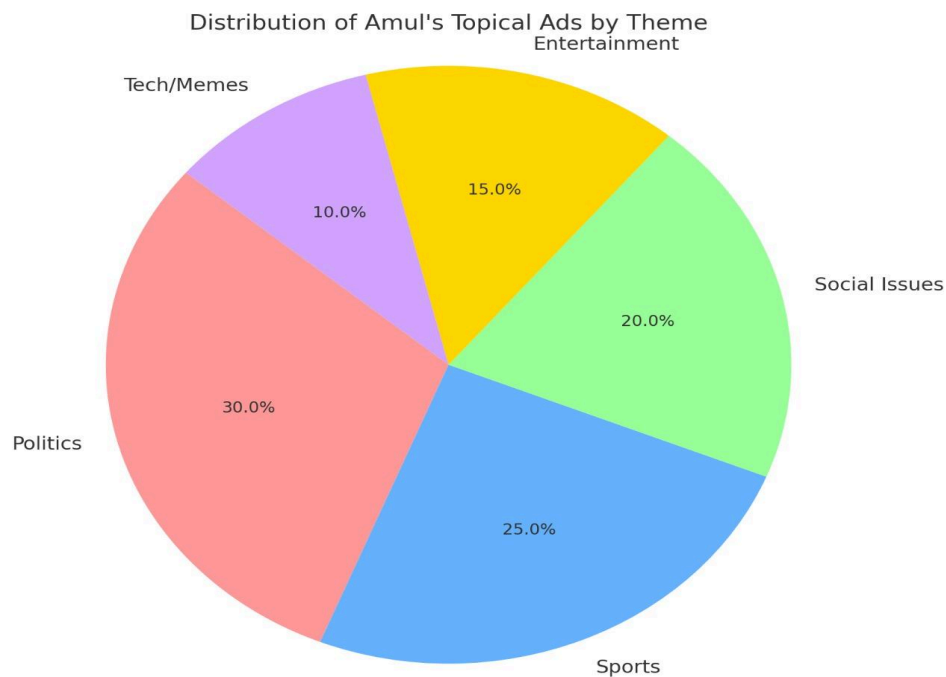


2. Amul quickly adjusted to the evolving situation by implementing strategic partnerships and launching new products. As lockdowns led to widespread supply chain disruptions, Amul was prepared by having pre-established partnerships with delivery apps. They teamed up with delivery apps such as Swiggy and BigBasket to adjust the increasing demand for e-commerce. Amul launched new immunity-boosting products like Haldi Doodh and Tulsi Ginger Milk to meet consumer demand. As a result of these strategic initiatives, Amul attained an 18% growth in revenue during the year 2020-2021. These efforts enhanced consumer loyalty and increased market share, solidifying Amul's position in the market.



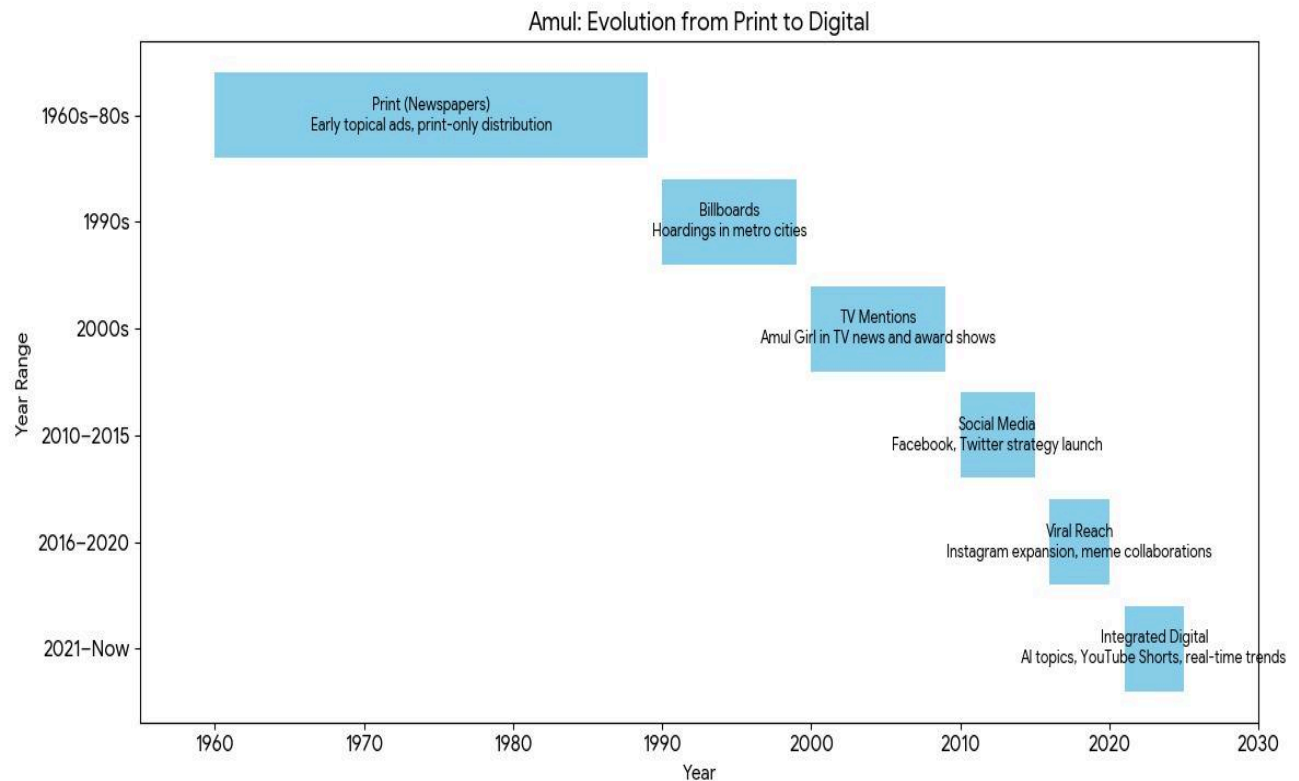
Amul motivated people to get vaccinated through a creative moment-based marketing ad.

Visual Analysis: Ads & Themes:



Pie chart showing the *distribution* of Amul's topical ads across major themes:

Timeline Chart: Evolution from Print to Digital



Strategy Breakdown:

Real-Time Responsiveness: The creative team at Amul is constantly tracking trends in news, pop culture, sports, politics, and social media, following all the latest trends and generating ideas. It quickly moves to press on most topical ads within hours of a trend breaking. The team has a dedicated in-house and agency (DaCunha Communications) working 24/7 to create content and engage in real-time.

Consistent Branding: The Amul Girl, the iconic mascot, has appeared in ads since the 1960s, making each ad memorable. The visual style, including hand-drawn, cartoon-style, and speech-bubble formats, has been a hit over generations.

Cultural Relevance: With ads in English and Hinglish, Amul strikes a chord with urban and semi-urban consumers, achieving a pan-India appeal. The diversity of topics, ranging from Bollywood and cricket to political changes and international issues- Amul does it all.

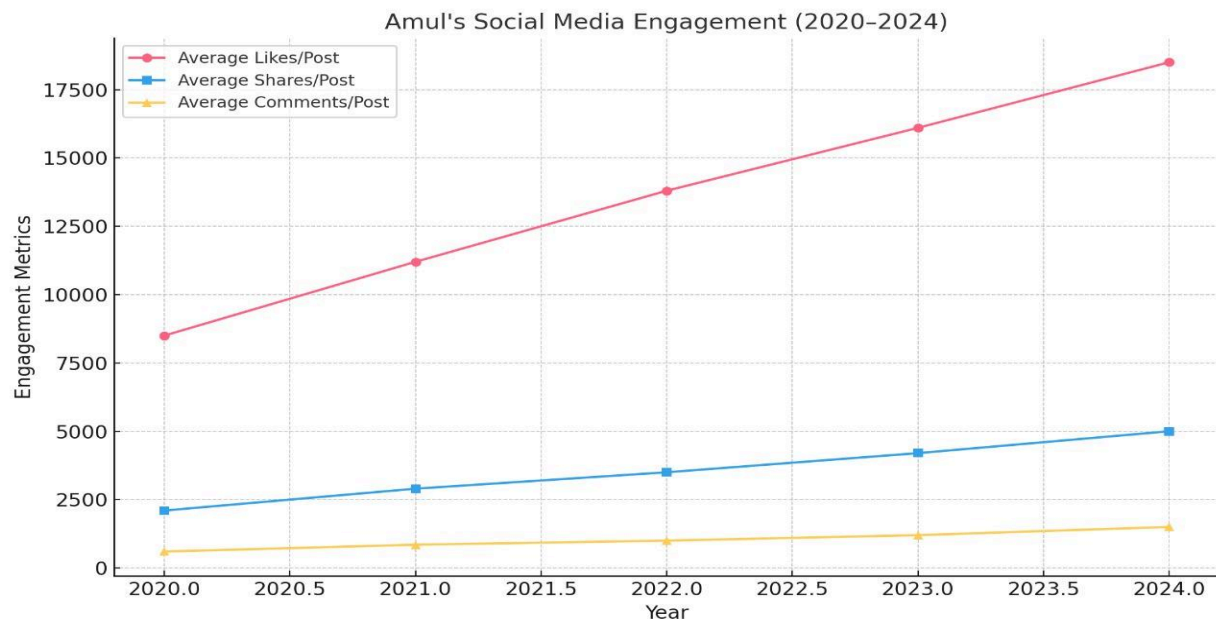
Low-Cost, High-Impact Execution: Amul focuses on billboard ads in major cities and newspaper inserts, achieving high visibility with low media costs. Their creative, funny approach makes Amul's ads go viral on social media without spending much money.

Agile Creative Process: Fast approvals and minimal bureaucracy enable Amul to release moment ads more quickly than its competitors. The interaction between DaCunha Communication and the brand team is frictionless with the two sides having worked together for decades.

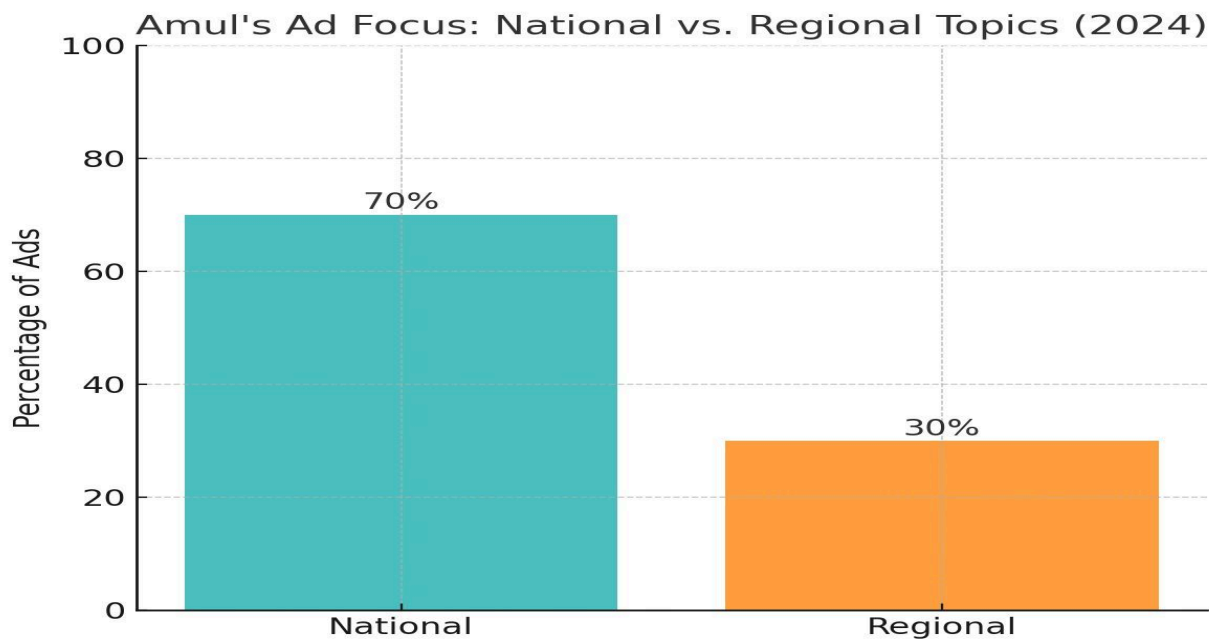
Engagement over Promotion: Moment ads gently drop include product mentions like “Utterly Butterly Delicious,” focusing more on storytelling than hard selling. Amul’s advertising on digital channels often leads to conversations, comments and shares.

Quantitative Analysis:

1. Social Media Engagement Over Time (2020–2024)



2. Regional vs National Topics (2024)



Competitor Comparison – Amul,Mother Dairy & Nestle(India):

Comparative Analysis Table

Brand	Brand Persona	Topical Content's Use	Topical Speed (Real-Time)	Consistency Over Years	Impact on Brand Recall
Amul	Witty, topical, socially aware	Very frequent; real-time ads on political, social, sports events	Very quick (often within 24 hours of the event)	Extremely consistent for 50+ years	Very high – iconic campaigns remembered for decades
Mother Dairy	Family-friendly, traditional, socially responsible	Rare; focuses more on seasonal	Slow; mostly thematic campaigns	Inconsistent, campaign-based	Moderate – known more for product quality

		themes & social messages			
Nestle	Premium, health-focused, globally oriented	Occasional; only for selected global events	Slow to moderate; more calculated and brand-safe	Consistent in branding, but moment marketing is not a major focus	High – trusted, but not moment-led recall

SWOT Analysis of Amul's Moment Marketing:

The engagement of moment marketing within the dairy industry of India With the focus shifting towards a healthier lifestyle among the common population, the dairy industry is blooming over the years.

Strength	Weaknesses
• Iconic Brand Mascot • Consistency Over Decades • Topical Relevance • High Engagement & Virality	• A bit too subtle for Gen Z • Limited real-time interaction • Print dependency-delay Use of reach can delay reach by copy.
Opportunities	Threats
• Expand real-time digital content • Collaborations with influencers • Product-Event Integration(For better ROI)	• Rising Competition • Audience fatigue from overuse • Changing Consumer Taste

The growth of Amul

1946

Kaira District Cooperative Milk Producers' Union Limited in Anand registered, marking the beginnings of Amul under Tribhuvandas Patel's leadership

1948

From just a few farmers, number increases to 432. Quantity of milk being pasteurised rises to 5000 litres a day



1949-50

Dr Verghese Kurien's first visits Anand in 1949; joins Amul in 1950

1955

New dairy launched by PM Jawaharlal Nehru paving the way for the Kaira Union to launch the brand Amul



1956

Production of ghee, butter and packaged milk begins



1962

Cheese launched in the market



1964

Lal Bahadur Shastri, the then Prime Minister of India, inaugurates Amul's Cattle Feed Plant in Anand



1965

The National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) is established at Anand

1966

Amul's advertising campaign begins with the first Amul butter hoarding making its appearance



SOURCE Amul

1969-70

NDDB comes up with dairy development programme for India popularly known as 'Operation Flood' or 'White Revolution'



1973

Gujarat Cooperative Milk Marketing Federation formed

1973

Amul launches its own brand of chocolates

1982

RS Sodhi joins Amul; Kurien takes Sodhi under his wing

1996

Amul launches ice cream

2001

The first Utterly Delicious parlour (Garden Parlour) opens in Ahmedabad



2006

Amul branches into coffee with Kool Café

2007

Sugar Free/Probiotic ice cream launched

2007

The federation becomes a billion dollar cooperative

2010

RS Sodhi takes charge as managing director of GCMMF

2012

Dr Verghese Kurien passes away

2017

Frozen snacks launched

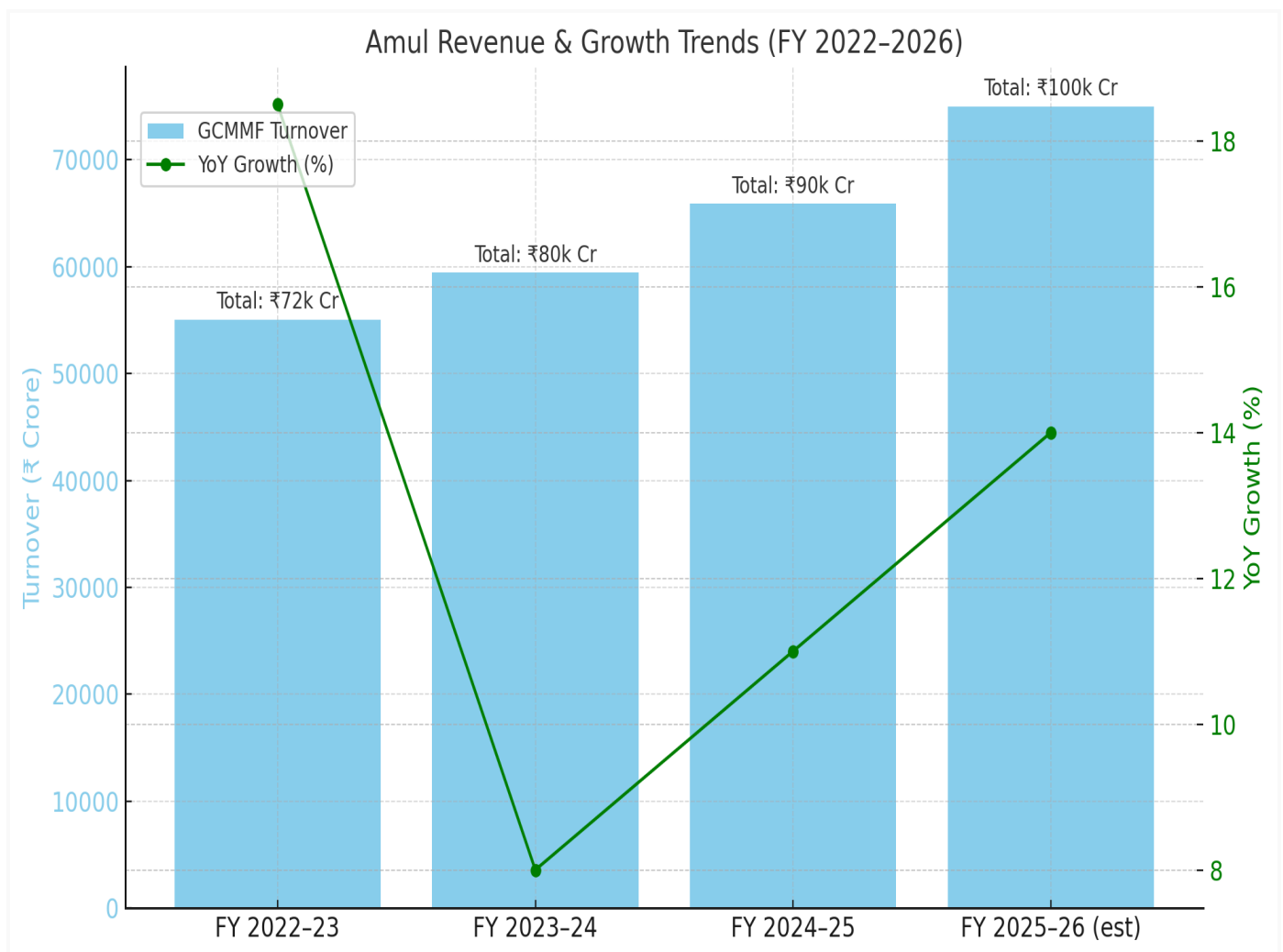
2019

Camel milk PET bottles launched

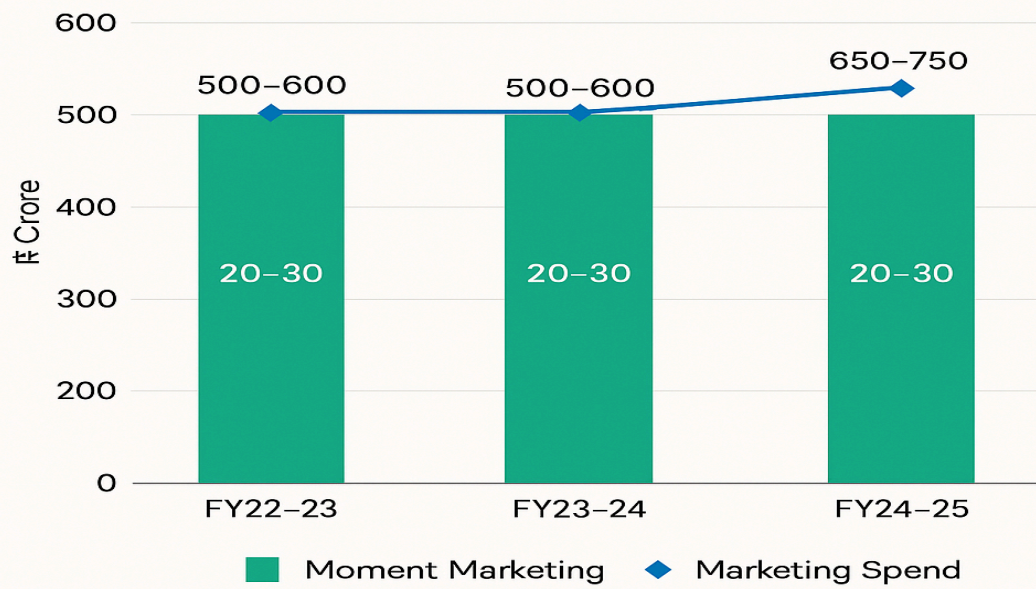
Marketing Spend, Valuation & Revenue Growth Trend:

Amul, managed by the Gujarat Cooperative Milk Marketing Federation (GCMMF), has experienced remarkable growth over the past decade. Its turnover surged from **₹8,005 crore in 2009-10** to **₹38,542 crore in 2019-20**. **By 2023**, Amul had reached **₹72,000 crore (around USD 9 billion)**, making it India's top FMCG brand and the **8th largest dairy company in the world**, according to ([Amul's official press release](#).)

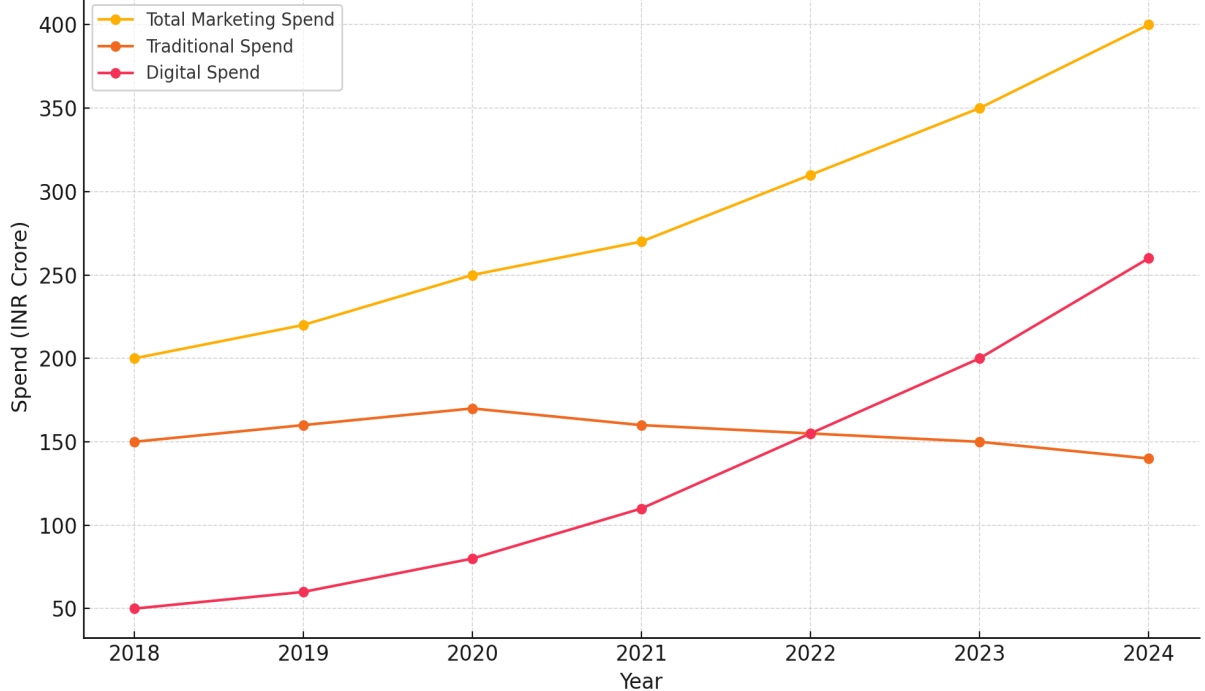
In **FY 2022-23**, Amul reported an impressive **18.5% growth**, adding **₹11,000 crore** to its topline in just one year. The brand's upward momentum continues, with a projected revenue of **₹80,000 crore for FY 2023-24**. Jayen Mehta, MD of GCMMF, as reported by [Exchange4Media](#), stated that Amul is aiming for a ₹1 lakh crore turnover by 2025(Expected data).



Revenue & Growth Trends: Marketing vs Moment Marketing (Annual)



Marketing Expenditure Trend (2018-2024)



****Amul has retained its position as India's top food brand, with brand value of USD 4.1 billion.**

Key takeaways from Amul:

1. Consistent Brand Voice Across Decades: For over 50 years, Amul has maintained the same character (the Amul Girl), bold typography, and witty tone in advertising. This consistency built instant recognition. Amul shows that long-term consistency creates deeper connections with customers.

2. Leveraging Emotion in Advertising: Amul's advertisements remind Indians of childhood memories and cultural traditions. The brand connects everyday moments like morning tea with their butter, creating emotions that go beyond product features. This emotional approach has created customer loyalty that price wars can't easily break.

3. Product-Market Fit & Regional Customization: Instead of forcing one standard product nationwide, Amul smartly adapts to regional preferences. This flexibility helped Amul succeed. They prove that listening to local tastes rather than imposing standardized products creates better customer satisfaction and sales results.

4. Building a Community-Driven Brand: Amul was community-focused before it became a marketing buzzword. The brand's very structure puts farmers at the center, giving them ownership and voice. This authentic community connection provides Amul with real stories.

Conclusion:

As Amul continues to grow and evolve, it will be interesting to see how the brand adapts its marketing strategy to stay relevant and competitive in an increasingly crowded and dynamic market. Amul's commitment to quality, innovation, and the welfare of its stakeholders will continue to be at the heart of its marketing efforts, ensuring that the brand remains a beloved and trusted name in the hearts and minds of Indian consumers for generations to come.

